1874
Peking October 2nd
Mr. Wade
No. 201
Recd. 9 Decr.

Ref. No. 198. China & Japan. Interview with Japanese Commissioner.

by Approve proceedings
Dec 7/74

For the Queen
& Mr Disraeli
Circulate

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202

Peking
2nd Oct 1874

My Lord,

The Ministers of the Yamên, as I have stated in the foregoing despatch of this date, come to the Legation to talk of the Japanese affair, tomorrow. I expect little or nothing from the conference. They, with the Prince of Kung at their head, are for peace; possibly at any price; but there is, I am

The Earl of Derby
&c &c

am credibly informed a powerful war party which includes the Prince of Chun, otherwise known as the Seventh Prince, the brother next junior to the Prince of Kung. These men entirely overlook the certain danger to which China is exposed, if in her present unprovided condition, she attempt the expulsion of the Japanese from Formosa *vi et armis*. The Japanese, unless I am misinformed,

have made arrangements which will enable them at a given moment to become masters of sufficient tonnage to transport a very large body of men to any point within a few days' reach of Japan. Were war declared, or if, as is too probable, the force that the Chinese are massing in Formosa, flounder into a collision with the Japanese there stationed, I should not look for anything on Formosa but a defence of the strong position now held by

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the Japanese. The game of the Government of Japan would be an immediate descent upon the coast, or upon the shores of the Great River, where a mere raid, if a long campaign be not in contemplation, can be made without doubt to pay.

I must be pardoned these speculations. There is not a hopeful sign on any side. The Central Government is wavering between its fears and its

pride

pride and every step it takes is indicative of weakness. The Grand Secretary Wênsiang, who has been attending to business as a convalescent, has once more, and very suddenly, asked for leave to retire. The Emperor has granted him three months leave for the benefit of his health, which is undoubtedly broken, but his real embarrassment is the crisis.

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I should ere this have decided whether it was my duty to remain here or to meet the Admiral at Shanghai, but for the non-arrival of my French colleague, whose return is hourly expected. In the next day or two I shall have seen whether, with his aid or without it, some thing may really be effected towards the averting of the calamity I apprehend.

If, as is too probable, the Chinese continue to rely upon an expression of opinion on the part of foreign ministers that the Japanese are in the wrong, I see no alternative but to proceed at once to Shanghai, and to consider with the Admiral what steps may be necessary or practicable for securing the British community against danger, and their trade against interruption. Sir Charles Shadwell will be at

Shanghai

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Shanghai at least until the 20th inst., and I shall endeavour on every ground to meet him before his departure from China.

I have the honor to be,

My Lord,

With the highest respect

Your Lordship's

Most obedient humble

Servant

Thomas Francis Wade

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1874.
Peking ÷ 2. October
Mr. Wade
No. 202

recd Dec 4
Ref: No 201
Japan & China
The Ministers of the Yamen come to talk over situation.

D. Mr Disraeli

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No. 203

Peking
9. October 1874.

My Lord,

I had the honor to transmit this day to Your Lordship, via Shanghai, the following Telegram in Cypher:

"With reference to Your "Lordship's Telegram of the 1st "Instant please refer to my Telegrams "of 24th April, 25th July, and "20th August. Letter from Admiral "yesterday says he had twice applied for

Earl of Derby